

DEGREE: BSc (HONS) Computer Science and Digitisation

Module: International Business Administration

Assignment Title: Individual Case Study

Assignment Type: Essay

Word Limit: 1500 words (+/- 200)

Weighting: 80%

Issue Date: 28/04/2026

Submission Date: 18/06/2026

Feedback Date: 02/07/2026

Plagiarism:

When submitting work for assessment, students should be aware of the InterActive/Canvas guidance and regulations in concerning plagiarism. All submissions should be your own, original work. Please note that you must not submit the same assignment for two different modules within your course.

You must submit an electronic copy of your work. Your submission will be electronically checked.

Learner declaration		
Word count		
Use of proof-reader/proof-reading service (see guidance contained in Academic Misconduct Regulations on appropriate use)	YES	NO
If 'yes', please specify which service (e.g. Grammarly, Studiosity etc.)		
I confirm that I submit this work as my own work and that I have cited all sources I have used, and I understand that using sources without citing them	YES	NO

correctly may be considered as Academic Misconduct.		
I confirm that I have followed guidance on the acceptable use of AI tools for this assignment where such guidance has been issued by my tutors.	YES	NO
Where use of appropriately cited use of AI tools is permitted, I confirm that I have cited in accordance with the UCA Harvard Referencing Standard.	YES	NO

Harvard Referencing:

The Harvard Referencing System must be used. The Wikipedia, UKEssays.com or similar websites must **not** be used or referenced in your work.

By submitting this assessment, you are confirming that you have understood and are complying with the University's Academic Misconduct Regulations.

Plagiarism Detection (Turnitin)

BSBI uses Turnitin (an on-line text matching tool) to help identify cases of plagiarism. Turnitin will compare a submitted assignment with a database of journal articles, books, web pages and previously submitted assignments.

Signature (Student): _____ Date: _____

In today's rapidly changing global environment, organisations are influenced by a range of external factors, including social, political, technological, and economic conditions. Understanding these factors is important for analysing how organisations operate and respond to challenges in different markets. This assignment provides an opportunity to explore the external business environment of a selected international organisation. You will identify key challenges, examine environmental factors, and present your findings in a clear and structured way.

Learning Outcomes:

LO1. Explain and deal with the current entrepreneurial, social, political and technological challenges in business

LO2. Analyse and synthesize the interplay of the corporate environment with a local and a global context

LO3. Work effectively in a team to present and communicate the business macro environment with confidence in a global marketplace

Assessment Criteria: Weighting 80%

1500 words

Tasks (All tasks are equally weighted):

For this assignment, you are required to select one international organisation of your choice. The organisation should operate in more than one country or have international activities.

Task 1 – Identifying and Organising Business Challenges (LO1 & LO3)

In today's dynamic business environment, organisations face a wide range of challenges across different areas such as entrepreneurial, social, political, and technological contexts.

Understanding the nature and impact of these challenges is essential for organisational survival and performance.

Based on your selected organisation, identify at least two challenges in each of the following areas: entrepreneurial, social, political, and technological. Explain each challenge and its relevance to the organisation. Then, rank and categorise these challenges based on their level of importance and impact on the organisation. Your work should be presented in a clear and structured manner.

Task 2 – Analysing the External Environment (LO2 & LO3)

Using a framework such as PESTEL, examine the organisation's external environment. Focus on how different factors are connected and how they shape the organisation's operations in both local and global contexts. Where possible, provide examples to support your explanation. Present your ideas in a logical and organised way to show clear communication of the business environment.

READING LISTS

Essential

Peng, M., Meyer K. (2019). International Business 3 ed, Cengage EMEA

Recommended

Wright Forrester (2018). Industrial Dynamics, Martino Fine Books

Assignment Structure

1. Introduction

- Brief introduction to the selected organisation
- Overview of the purpose of the assignment
- Outline of the main sections

2. Business Challenges

- Identification of key entrepreneurial, social, political, and technological challenges
- Explanation of how these challenges affect the organisation
- Ranking and categorisation of challenges based on importance and impact

3. External Environment Analysis

- Application of a framework such as PESTEL
- Identification of key external factors
- Explanation of how these factors influence the organisation in local and global contexts

4. Conclusion

- Summary of the main findings
- Brief reflection on the importance of understanding the business environment

5. References

- All sources must be properly cited using Harvard referencing style

Notes

- The word count applies to the main body of the essay and does not include the reference list or appendices.
- Students are required to use the official university assignment template, which is available on Canvas.
- All materials must be properly referenced under Harvard conventions.
- The writing style should be formal academic writing style with in-text referencing to support your comments and observations.
- Originality, clarity of explanation, and good structure are required. The essay should demonstrate understanding and ability to apply knowledge of the business environment in an international context.

Students are encouraged to explore additional reputable sources in the digital library beyond the list provided to strengthen their individual research and critical analysis skills. The unit lecturer can help with recommending additional literature.

The criteria for successfully passing the units with two assessment components require passing both components successfully. Passing marks for BSc and MA/MSc levels are different and are stated at the end of the assignment brief. Please find the examples below:

- **Example 1** (e.g., pass mark: 50)
 - Component 1 (50% weighting) - 55
 - Component 2 (50% weighting) - 55
 - Final average: 55
 - Result: **Pass (both components passed and therefore the unit is passed)**

- **Example 2** (e.g., pass mark: 50)
 - Component 1 (50% weighting) – 80
 - Component 2 (50% weighting) – 30
 - Final average: 55
 - Result: **Fail (because although the average is above 50, one of the components is a failure)**

GUIDANCE ON ASSESSMENT

All materials must be properly referenced under Harvard conventions. The length required is 1500 words with tasks equally weighted. The writing style should be formal academic / report writing style with in-text referencing to support your comments and observations. Originality, quality of argument and good structure are required. The essay should demonstrate sound understanding and ability to apply knowledge and theory of the business environment in an international context. Additional marks being awarded for juxtaposition and insight of issues.

Grading Criteria

	Generic Criteria	90 - 100	80 - 89	70 - 79	60 - 69	50 - 59	40 - 49	30 - 39	0 - 29
Level 4	Knowledge of contexts, concepts, technologies and processes The extent to which knowledge is demonstrated: <i>relevant contextual or theoretical issues are identified, defined and described</i> <i>historical or contemporary practices are identified, defined and described</i> <i>appropriate technologies, methods and processes are identified, defined and described</i>	Outstanding breadth of knowledge of fundamental contextual and theoretical issues and critical concepts and their relationship to historical and contemporary practices Extensive knowledge of relevant and specialist technologies and processes	Extensive knowledge of fundamental contextual and theoretical issues and critical concepts and a widening appreciation of historical and contemporary practices In depth and broadening knowledge of appropriate technologies and processes	Significant knowledge of fundamental contextual and theoretical issues and critical concepts and a widening appreciation of historical and contemporary practices Significant knowledge of appropriate technologies and processes	Confident familiarity with fundamental contextual and theoretical issues and critical concepts Thorough knowledge of appropriate technologies and processes	Familiar with fundamental contextual and theoretical issues and critical concepts Sound knowledge of appropriate technologies and processes	Adequate knowledge of fundamental contextual and theoretical issues and critical concepts Adequate knowledge of appropriate technologies and processes	Limited knowledge of fundamental contextual and theoretical issues and critical concepts Limited knowledge of appropriate technologies and processes	Little or no knowledge of fundamental contextual and theoretical issues or critical concepts Little or no knowledge of appropriate technologies or processes
	Understanding through application of knowledge The degree to which research methods are demonstrated: <i>relevant knowledge and information is compared, contrasted, manipulated, translated and interpreted</i> <i>knowledge and information is selected, analysed, synthesized and evaluated in order to generate creative ideas, practices, solutions, arguments or hypotheses</i>	Relevant knowledge is explored and interpreted when proposing solutions to projects and problems which demonstrate evidence of independent thought Outstanding ability to analyse and synthesise knowledge to produce own creative practice in standard situations and to evaluate results	Deep level of comprehension and exploration of relevant knowledge in seeking solutions to projects or problems Outstanding ability to analyse and synthesise knowledge in order to produce creative practice in standard situations and to evaluate the results	Deep level of comprehension of relevant knowledge in seeking solutions to projects or problems Strong ability to apply and analyse knowledge to produce creative practice in standard situations, with some evaluation of the results	Strong comprehension of relevant knowledge in seeking solutions to projects or problems Sound ability to apply and analyse knowledge to produce creative practice in standard situations	Sound comprehension of relevant knowledge in seeking solutions to projects or problems Sound ability to apply knowledge to produce creative practice in standard situations	Surface-level comprehension of relevant knowledge in seeking solutions to projects or problems Competent application of knowledge to the production of creative practice in standard situations	Incomplete comprehension of relevant knowledge in seeking solutions to projects or problems Limited ability to apply knowledge to produce creative practice in standard situations	Little or no comprehension of relevant knowledge in seeking solutions to projects or problems Little or no ability to apply relevant knowledge to produce creative practice in standard situations
	Application of technical and professional skills The degree to which:	Accomplished and fluent application of appropriate practical and technical skills	Relevant, accomplished and fluent application of basic practical and technical skills	Relevant and accomplished application of basic practical and technical skills	Strong application of basic practical and technical skills	Sound application of basic practical and technical skills	Competent application of practical and technical skills	Rudimentary application of basic practical and technical skills	Scant application of basic practical and technical skills

<i>appropriate materials and media are selected, tested and utilised to realise and present ideas and solutions</i> <i>appropriate technologies, methods and processes are demonstrated</i> <i>transferable, professional skills are effectively demonstrated</i> <i>self management and independent learning are demonstrated</i>	Outstanding application of appropriate transferable and professional skills Significant ability to learn independently and critically evaluate own progress using a wide range of feedback sources	Outstanding application of fundamental transferable and professional skills Substantial ability to work independently and use feedback to reflect critically on own progress	Highly effective application of fundamental transferable and professional skills Strong ability to work independently and use feedback to plan future tasks effectively	Strong application of fundamental transferable and professional skills Evidence of developing well as an independent learner	Sound application of fundamental transferable and professional skills Evidence of beginning to develop as an independent learner	Competent application of fundamental transferable and professional skills Adequate evidence of beginning to develop as an independent learner	Limited application of fundamental transferable and professional skills Limited evidence of ability to learn independently	Ineffective application of fundamental transferable and professional skills Little or no evidence of ability to learn independently
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